Year 7 Admission Assessment: assessor booklet

For students applying to join **Year 7** (age 11 to 12 on 1 September). A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 5** and is the same age as a student starting Grade 6. The maths paper tests UK Year 6 content, so several topics (ratio, percentages, circles, negative numbers, pie charts, coordinates with negative numbers, multiplying and dividing fractions) **may not have been taught yet**. Section 4 lists them. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Notes
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler	Script in Section 2
2	Listening (paper pages 2 to 3)	5	Assessor reads the script twice	This booklet, Section 3.1	Can be done with a small group
3	Reading paper (pages 4 to 9)	12	Student works alone; assessor times	Clock or timer	Do not read the texts aloud
4	Writing (pages 10 to 11)	10	Student works alone		Choose one of two tasks
5	Break	3 to 5		Water	
6	Maths (pages 12 to 16)	20	Student; assessor may read questions aloud	No calculator, no protractor	Section A number problems, Section B word problems and pictures
7	Science (pages 17 to 19)	8	Student; assessor may read questions aloud		
8	Interview, opening with sentence reading	15	Interviewer, 1:1	`forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, a plain card	Sentence reading starts at **Level 6** (sentence 16)
	Total	**about 70**			Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate)

Print for each candidate: the Year 7 student paper (19 pages, A4), the interview record (Years 7 to 10), the sentence reading record, the parent conversation record and the candidate summary. **Print once per room:** this booklet and the sentence reading card (laminate it). The score summary (Section 6) can be copied, one per candidate.

2. Before you start

Welcome script. Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

Access rules (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff. In English sections only English answers score, but note anything the student says or writes in Chinese, because it shows understanding.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Answers in Chinese are accepted in explanations (mark **L**).
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary.

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it in the score summary.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. In the reading paper, Part C is meant to stretch: if the student is clearly stuck after Part B, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." In writing, if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it.
- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part.

3. English

3.1 Listening (5 minutes, 8 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Listening page. I am going to read a phone message. Li Na is calling her friend Sofia. I will read it two times. First, read the questions." Give the student **one minute** to look at all eight questions (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part of the message, and do not explain any word.

Script: a phone message

Hi Sofia, it's Li Na. I'm calling about our plan for Saturday. **[pause]**

The cinema in Riverside Mall is closed this weekend, so we can't see the film. Let's go to the science museum instead. **[pause]**

We can meet outside the main entrance at half past nine. Please don't be late, because the first show in the space theatre starts at ten o'clock. **[pause]**

The easiest way to get there is by metro. Take Line 2 and get off at Lakeside Station. Then use Exit 4. The museum is right in front of you. **[pause]**

Tickets are usually 40 yuan, but students only pay 25 yuan, so remember to bring your student card. **[pause]**

Oh, and bring a packed lunch. The café in the museum is really expensive, and we can eat in the garden. **[pause]**

My dad is picking us up at four o'clock, so you don't need to take the metro home. **[pause]**

My brother Jun went to the museum last week. He's fourteen, and he thinks everything is boring. But even he said the robot exhibition was amazing! It closes on Sunday, so this is our last chance to see it. **[pause]**

> Please send me a message tonight and tell me if you can come. Bye!

Answers. One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** science museum		A (cinema): heard "cinema" but missed "closed". C: heard "Mall".
2	**B** 9:30		C (10:00): heard the time of the show, not the meeting time.
3	**B** metro		C (car): heard "My dad is picking us up", which is for going home.
4	**Both** student card **and** packed lunch		One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Money for the café" is a distractor.
5	**4**	four	2 (the metro line).
6	**25**	25 yuan, ¥25	40 (the usual price): missed "but students only pay".
7	The first show (in the space theatre) starts at ten.	They will miss the show; the show is at 10; they must be there before the show.	"Because they meet at half past nine" with no reason.
8	To show that the robot exhibition must be very good: even her brother, who thinks everything is boring, liked it.	To make Sofia want to come; because the robots are amazing; because it is good and it closes soon.	"Because he is fourteen"; "because he is boring".

Band guide (listening, / 8): 0 to 2 **A** · 3 to 4 **B** · 5 to 6 **C** · 7 **D** · 8 **E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 4 test gist and detail with a distractor in each. A student who chooses the distractor every time is catching single words ("cinema", "ten", "dad") without the sentence around them: typical of band B.
- Questions 7 and 8 need inference. A fluent Year 7 listener gets both quickly. Short answers are fine: the writing is not marked here.
- **English barrier or something else?** If a student scores low but follows your spoken instructions easily, check whether the problem was speed (they may do better in conversation) or attention. Note it for the interview.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, 24 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are three parts. They get harder. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

Mark scheme. Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question. Answers in Chinese do not score, but note them.

Part A: After-school clubs (a notice; very accessible, with pictures)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	Tuesday	Tue	
2	Room 14	14	Library
3	5:30 pm	5:30, half past five, 17:30	4:15
4	Basketball		
5	a False · b True · c False		1 mark for each correct row (3 marks)
6	Drama	Drama Club	Art

Part B: Kites (non-fiction, about two years below age level)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	wood		
8	more than two thousand years	over 2000 years; 2000 years; two thousand years	
9	B		
10	It keeps the kite steady.	It stops the kite spinning (round and round); it helps it stay still or balanced.	It makes the kite fly; it holds the kite.
11	a True · b False		1 mark each
12	They cost less money.		
13	There are no trees or wires for the kite to get caught in.	It is safe; there is space to run or to fly it; nothing is in the way; there is more wind.	Answers that only repeat "a park or a beach" with no reason.

Part C: Mist (fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 11)

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
14	Retrieval	Next to Tom	By the window; at the empty desk by the window	
15	Retrieval	A place they loved	A favourite place; a place they like	His grandfather's tea garden (what Chen Yu drew, not what was asked)
16	Inference	He was alone and did not want people to see it.	He had nobody to talk to; he was shy, nervous or lonely; he did not know anyone; so nobody would notice him	He was hungry; the rice was hot
17	Vocabulary in context	flow fast, like a river		
18	Inference with evidence (2)	**1 mark** for a feeling: nervous, shy, lonely, worried, scared, uncomfortable, sad, alone, not happy. **1 mark** for evidence that fits: he counted the faces; nobody looked up; he kept his eyes on the board; he copied every word; Tom did not say a word; he sat at the end of the table; he ate slowly to look busy.	Evidence in the student's own words	A positive feeling ("happy", "excited") scores 0 for the feeling; the evidence mark can still be given if the evidence is correct.
19	Why do you think	To make a joke; to make Chen Yu feel welcome or relaxed.	To show the club is friendly and you do not need to be good at sport; because Tom is bad at football too; to make him laugh	"Because they play football in the club"
20	Author's purpose	The grey streets show Chen Yu's feelings: he feels happier or more hopeful now, because he has made a friend.	He is not lonely now; his day got better; things seem better because of Tom and the art club	"Because the rain stopped" (not in the text: a literal reading; note it)

Band guide (reading paper). Use the part scores, in this order:

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B**

Result	Band
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C**
Part C 3 to 5	**D**
Part C 6 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example a high Part C with a low Part B, which can happen when a student ran out of time or misread one instruction), and check against the sentence reading screen in the interview.

What to look for

- Strong readers answer Part C questions 16, 18 and 20 in their own words and link feelings to evidence. Weaker readers copy a nearby sentence whether or not it answers the question.
- A student who does Parts A and B well but leaves Part C blank may have run out of time rather than understanding. Note where they stopped at 12 minutes.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** Most students in this pack are learning English, so low scores usually reflect vocabulary. If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

The tasks

- **Task 1 (narrative):** a story that begins "When Mei opened the box, she could not believe her eyes."
- **Task 2 (opinion):** "The school summer holiday should be shorter." Do you agree?

Marking. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task.	A short response that follows the task; ideas listed with simple links ("and", "then"); a beginning but a weak or missing ending; little paragraphing.	A complete, well-shaped story or argument for the age: an opening that sets the scene or position, ideas developed with detail or reasons and examples, a clear ending; paragraphs; the reader is kept in mind.
Vocabulary	Single memorised words or copied words.	Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese.	A wide range for the age, chosen for effect (precise verbs and adjectives, some less common words); words for linking ideas ("however", "although", "for example").
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Simple sentences, some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear.	Varied sentences, including complex ones ("When ...", "which ...", "if ..."); tenses controlled (past for the story, present for the opinion); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation.	Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly.	Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas, question marks, apostrophes and speech marks mostly correct.

Rough guide to the total (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E writing at Year 7. Comparable to a fluent writer of 11 or 12. In 10 minutes, usually 150 to 250 words in clear paragraphs. The story has a real event and an ending, with some dialogue or description; the opinion gives a clear view, two or three reasons with examples, and often mentions the other side. Sentences are varied and controlled,

vocabulary is chosen with care, and errors are few and minor. Some fluent writers write less in 10 minutes but very well: judge quality, not just length.

What to look for

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- A student who writes a strong plan but few lines may think well but write slowly in English: note it.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses. Writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught through grammar and textbook dialogues.

3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1 and uses **`forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`**. It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen** (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`): for Year 7, **start at Level 6 (sentence 16)**, and follow the rules on the record for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors on the interview record. Copy the sentence reading total, reading age and the speaking band into the score summary.

The interview record's opinion questions include homework and phones. These do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

4. Maths (20 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths pages. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and problems with pictures. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 20 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not learnt the topic.

Marking. Accept any clear, correct method. Accept equivalent answers (for example 6/15 for 2/5) unless the question says otherwise. Units are printed on the paper, so a missing unit does not lose a mark. Where a method mark is shown, give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip.

Section A: Number problems (11 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	7244	1		Addition (floor item)
2	9342	1	Common slips: 6920 + 2422 added wrongly; 346 × 2 instead of × 20 (3114).	Long multiplication (floor item)
3	a 17 · b 6	1 + 1	a: 32 means the student worked from left to right. b: 2.4 (12 ÷ 5) means the student added before dividing; 18 means the brackets were ignored.	Order of operations
4	36	2	**1 mark** for a correct method (long or short division, chunking such as 24 × 30 = 720, remainder 144 = 24 × 6) with one arithmetic error.	Long division
5	2/5	1	6/15, 0.4	Multiplying fractions
6	1/4	1	3/12, 0.25. 9/4 means the student multiplied.	Dividing a fraction by a whole number
7	60 (%)	1		Fraction, decimal and percentage equivalence
8	12	1		Percentage of an amount
9	−13	1	13, −3 or 3 show a sign error.	Negative numbers (Year 7 content: ceiling item)

Section B: Word problems and pictures (19 marks). W = word problem (8 marks in all).

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
10 **W**	1800 (cm^3)	1	One-step, measures. 41 (adding) means the student did not know volume.	Volume of a cuboid
11	a 30 · b 40 (cm^2)	1 + 1	a: 60 forgot to halve. b: 48 used the sloping side (8 × 6).	Area of a triangle and a parallelogram
12 **W**	450 (g)	1	Two-step: 300 ÷ 4 × 6, or 300 + 150. 600 (doubled) or 306 (added 6) are common errors.	Ratio and scaling
13	a = 50, b = 55 (degrees)	1 + 1	b: follow through from a wrong a: give the mark for 180 − 75 − (their a) if positive. a = 130 confuses vertically opposite angles with angles on a straight line.	Vertically opposite angles; angles in a triangle
14	radius **B**, diameter **C**, circumference **A**	1	All three correct for the mark.	Parts of a circle (English vocabulary)
15 **W**	180 (yuan)	2	Multi-step, money and percentages. **1 mark** for 60 seen (25% of 240), or for 3/4 × 240 or 240 × 0.75 with an arithmetic slip. 60 as the final answer scores 1. 215 (took away 25) scores 0.	Percentages of amounts

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
16	a 1/4 · b 20	1 + 1	a: 25%, 0.25, 30/120, 90/360. b: 60/360 × 120. 60 (the angle) scores 0.	Pie charts
17 **W**	a 26 · b 15	1 + 1	Multi-step, money, a formula. a: 10 + 2 × 8. 96 (10 + 2 then × 8) is an order of operations error. b: (40 – 10) ÷ 2. 20 (40 ÷ 2) ignores the starting cost.	Simple formulae; missing numbers
18	a (–3, 4) · b (–3, –2)	1 + 1	Brackets not needed if the order is clear. If **both** answers have x and y the wrong way round, give 1 mark in total and note it.	Coordinates in four quadrants
19	a 16 · b 3*n* + 1	1 + 1	b: 3 × *n* + 1, 1 + 3*n*, "multiply by 3 and add 1". "Add 3" (the term-to-term rule) scores 0 but shows partial understanding: note it.	The nth term (b is a ceiling item)
20 **W**	a 5 · b 11	1 + 1	Multi-step. b: 6 × 6 = 36, 36 – 25 = 11. 6 or 7 are common guesses.	The mean (b is a ceiling item)

Totals: Section A / 11 · Section B / 19 · **of which word problems / 8** (questions 10, 12, 15, 17 and 20).

Band guide (maths, / 30; provisional): 0 to 11 **1** Well below expected · 12 to 17 **2** Working towards · 18 to 25 **3** Expected · 26 to 30 **4** Greater depth. List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

May not have been taught. A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 5 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 6 or later, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

Questions	Topic	Usually taught in China
5, 6	Multiplying and dividing fractions	Grade 6
7, 8, 15	Percentages	Grade 6
9	Negative numbers	Grade 6 (operations in Grade 7)
12	Ratio (the scaling method itself is familiar)	Grade 6
13	Vertically opposite angles (angle sum of a triangle is Grade 4)	Grade 7
14	Parts of a circle	Grade 6
16	Pie charts	Grade 6
18	Coordinates with negative numbers (first-quadrant number pairs may be known from Grade 5)	Grade 7
19b	A rule for the nth term (pattern spotting is common; letters for numbers is Grade 5)	Not taught formally

Usually **familiar**: addition, long multiplication and division, order of operations (Grade 4), area of triangles and parallelograms and volume of cuboids (Grade 5), simple formulae and equations (Grade 5), the mean (Grade 4).

What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** Compare Section A with the word problems (W). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an **English barrier** rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the student then solves it, record that the barrier is English.
- Strong students show efficient written methods, check answers, and get the ceiling items (9, 19b, 20b). Many students from Chinese schools calculate quickly and accurately but leave out working: that is fine when the answer is right.
- A low score that is mostly NT topics (circles, percentages, pie charts, negative numbers, coordinates) is not the same as a low score on taught topics (calculation, area, volume, the mean). Say which in the summary.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science pages. There are 6 questions. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable (for example "ginko", "oxigen").

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	A ginkgo · B maple · C lotus	2	**2** for all three; **1** for two. Uses a key (working scientifically).	Classification keys
2	oxygen	1	Carbon dioxide is a common confusion (it is given out in the lungs).	The heart and blood
3	a 130 · b His muscles need more oxygen (or energy), so the heart pumps blood faster to carry it to them.	1 + 1	a: reading a graph between labelled gridlines. b: accept "his body needs more oxygen", "to get more energy to the muscles", "more blood goes to the muscles". Not: "because he is tired", "because running is hard".	Exercise and health; reading a graph
4	a bulb, switch, cell (left to right) · b **B**	1 + 1	a: all three for the mark. b: C (two bulbs) means the student thinks more bulbs give more light.	Circuit symbols; more cells and brighter bulbs
5	a the puppet she uses · b smaller	1 + 1	b: shorter, small, lower, less tall. "Bigger" means the table was read the wrong way.	Light and shadows; fair tests and variables; reading a table
6	The rocks were once under the sea.	1	The land or mountain was once the sea bed; the sea was there long ago; the rocks moved up from the sea. Not: "the animals climbed up", "a bird carried them".	Fossils and evolution

Band guide (science, / 10; provisional): 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

May not have been taught. Primary science (科学) in China covers these areas but the textbooks differ, so a Year 7 entrant **may not have been taught**: dichotomous keys (Q1; sorting living things is usually familiar), the heart and circulation in detail (Q2, Q3b; this comes fully in Grade 7 biology), circuit symbols (Q4a; circuits are Grade 4, often with drawings rather than symbols), and fossils and evolution (Q6). Light and shadows (Q5) are usually taught in Grade 5.

What to look for

- Questions 1, 3 and 5 test working scientifically (using a key, reading a graph and a table, fair tests). A student who does these well thinks scientifically even if the topic knowledge is NT.
- Short or one-word answers are fine. If the student explains in Chinese (L), note how good the science is: this separates a science difficulty from an English barrier.

6. Score summary

Candidate name	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	/ 8	A B C D E	
Reading paper	/ 24 (A / 8, B / 8, C / 8)	A B C D E	Where did the student stop at 12 minutes?
Sentence reading (shared record)	points / 72 (36 sentences), reading age	indicative A B C D E	Meaning checks, fluency
Writing	/ 16 (content / 4, vocabulary / 4, grammar / 4, spelling and punctuation / 4)	A B C D E	Task chosen: 1 2
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	/ 30 (A / 11, B / 19, of which word problems / 8)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Science	/ 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:

Number problems against word problems: Section A ___ / 11 (___ %) and word problems ___ / 8 (___ %). If the word problem percentage is much lower, was the barrier English? (Tick if a word problem was solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.) ☐

Overall English band (the band most of the four skills sit in; name any skill two or more bands below the others): **A B C D E**

Comments (strengths, gaps, NT topics, what support the student would need):

Assessor signature and date _____

Copy these results onto `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.